

INITIAL LANGUAGE EVALUATION REPORT

Déborah Vichith

Linguaid France — Confidential

Field	Details
Candidate	Déborah Vichith
Email	vichith@hec.fr
Department	Accueil
Job Title	Hôtesse d'accueil
Written Test Date	18 June 2026
Oral Session Date	24 June 2026
Evaluator	Anna MALZY

1. Executive Summary

Déborah Vichith completed both a written placement test and an oral assessment with Linguaid France in June 2026. Across all five assessed skill areas, her profile is that of a **developing intermediate learner** whose receptive skills (reading, listening, pronunciation) outperform her productive skills (speaking, writing). Her overall consolidated level is assessed at **B1 (2)**.

Déborah is a motivated learner with a strong practical orientation, good listening comprehension, and generally clear pronunciation. However, her spoken production is currently limited by a lack of confidence, restricted grammatical range, and a tendency to disengage when she cannot immediately retrieve the word or structure she needs. Her written production shows more promise, with clear communicative intent, though tense control and professional register require significant development.

Given her role at the main reception desk of HEC — where she manages visitor and student interactions, answers questions, solves problems, and writes professional emails — her training needs are both specific and urgent. A targeted **10-hour training plan** focused on professional telephone English, email writing, and spoken interaction at the welcome desk is recommended, with sessions delivered by video call on Wednesday afternoons.

| Overall CEFR Profile

Skill	Level
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Reading / Vocabulary	B1+ (2.5)
Grammar (MCQ)	B1+ (2.5)
Writing	B1 (2)
Listening	B1 (2)
Speaking	A2 (1)
Overall Consolidated Level	B1 (2)

2. Skill-by-Skill Assessment

| 2.1 Reading and Vocabulary

Level: B1+ (2.5)

Strengths

- Déborah demonstrates a solid passive vocabulary range appropriate to the B1+ band
- She uses domain-relevant lexical items naturally in her writing (*reception, holiday, moving in*), suggesting reliable reading comprehension of familiar professional texts
- Her vocabulary choices across written responses (*free time, take care of, finish*) indicate she can retrieve and activate a range of everyday and workplace words without apparent difficulty
- Comprehension of oral input during the assessment session was strong, confirming that her reading and listening vocabulary are her most developed assets

Development Areas

- **Collocational range** is limited at the upper-intermediate level — she has not yet acquired the natural word partnerships a B2 speaker would use (e.g., *handle enquiries, transfer a call, liaise with visitors, schedule an appointment*)
- **Professional and hospitality register** will require targeted input, particularly for the written and spoken interactions she manages daily at HEC
- **Phrasal verb accuracy** needs attention — she produced *moved out* where *moved around* was intended, suggesting her recognition of phrasal verbs does not yet extend reliably to accurate active use

| 2.2 Writing

Level: B1 (2)

Strengths

- All three written responses communicate their intended meaning clearly and without serious breakdown
- Déborah writes in **short, clean sentences** that do not overcomplicate structure — a pragmatic and effective approach at her current level
- She demonstrates emerging clause-level complexity, for example using a well-formed subordinate time clause: *"when I have free time"*
- Her writing style is coherent and uncluttered, providing a good foundation on which to build professional email writing skills

Development Areas

- **Tense control** is the most significant writing gap: she uses the present simple where the past simple is required (*"I grow up" → "I grew up"*), and the past simple where a conditional or future form is needed (*"I liked to finish" → "I would like to finish"*)
- **Irregular past simple verb forms** present a recurring difficulty — high-frequency items such as *grow/grew*, *know/knew*, *write/wrote* will appear constantly in professional written exchanges
- **Future and conditional structures** (*will / going to / would like to / present progressive for plans*) require dedicated attention, as errors in this area can cause genuine miscommunication in professional emails and scheduling contexts
- **Prepositions of place versus direction** produce interference-driven errors (*"to the main reception" → "at the main reception"*), a pattern rooted in French (*à l'accueil*) that will need explicit correction
- **Professional register** — Déborah does not yet consistently use the fixed phrases and collocations expected in formal workplace writing; developing a small set of email templates for her most frequent use cases would be a high-impact early goal
- **Basic writing conventions** — capitalisation of *I* is inconsistent, which would be notable in professional correspondence

| 2.3 Grammar

Level: B1+ (2.5)

Strengths

- An MCQ score of **23/30 (77%)** places Déborah confidently in the B1+ band and confirms a reliable working knowledge of core intermediate grammar structures
- She handles **basic present simple and continuous** accurately in context
- **Coordinating conjunctions** are used naturally and correctly to link clauses
- **Article use** and **basic prepositions** are generally accurate in familiar contexts
- Her overall grammar foundation is solid enough to support structured training at the B1-B2 transition level

Development Areas

- **Irregular past simple verb forms** — errors on high-frequency items (*grow* → *grew*) suggest this paradigm has not been fully consolidated and will require systematic review
- **Future and conditional structures** — the confusion between past simple, *would like to*, and present progressive for future plans is the single most significant grammar gap identified, with direct implications for professional communication
- **Prepositions of place and direction** — the *at / in / to* distinction remains unstable, driven by French interference, and requires targeted contrast work
- **Phrasal verb accuracy** — particularly verbs of movement (*move out / move around*) and professional action (*put someone through, get back to, deal with*), where confusion between similar forms could affect both clarity and professional impression

| 2.4 Listening

Level: B1 (2)

Strengths

- Déborah's listening comprehension was a clear highlight of the oral session — she followed questions and conversational input consistently without asking for repetition
- Her ability to process spoken English at natural pace suggests she has built strong receptive habits, likely reinforced by her habit of watching films and television series in English
- She self-corrected on pronunciation a couple of times during the session, which indicates active monitoring and awareness of her own output — a strong metacognitive asset
- The gap between her listening level (B1) and speaking level (A2) is a recognisable and workable profile: comprehension capacity is ahead of production, which typically facilitates faster spoken progress with the right support

Development Areas

- While listening comprehension is generally good, Déborah would benefit from exposure to **professional listening contexts** — telephone calls, visitor queries, recorded announcements — to build familiarity with the pace and register of workplace English
- Developing the ability to **listen for specific information** under time pressure (e.g., taking a message, noting a room number, understanding a complaint) will be essential for her role

| 2.5 Speaking

Level: A2 (1)

Strengths

- Déborah's **pronunciation** is generally clear and intelligible — she was understood consistently throughout the session and self-corrected appropriately when she noticed an error
- She demonstrated some functional spoken range: she can introduce herself, describe her work and personal life, and respond to direct questions on familiar topics
- Her **listening-to-speaking ratio** is positive — she processes what she hears well, which means the foundational comprehension needed for interaction is in place

Development Areas

- **Fluency and confidence** are the most pressing spoken concerns: Déborah uses the phrase *"that's it"* as a conversational exit strategy whenever she cannot immediately retrieve a word or structure, effectively closing down exchanges rather than managing them. This pattern will need direct attention in training through strategies for paraphrasing, buying time, and staying in the conversation
- **Plural forms** are inconsistently applied — she produced *"a lot of phone call," "many professor,"* and *"a lot of persons"* during the session, suggesting that plural morphology (*phone calls, professors, people*) has not been reliably automatised in spontaneous speech
- **Past tense production** in speech mirrors written gaps: she uses *was* with some confidence but hesitates with regular and irregular simple past forms, and the present perfect was entirely absent despite prompting — a notable gap for a B1 oral level
- **Spoken professional vocabulary** needs significant development: she does not yet have ready access to the fixed phrases and functional language needed to manage reception interactions (e.g., *"How can I help you?"*, *"Let me transfer you," "I'll find out and get back to you"*), which directly affects her ability to perform her role in English
- **Interaction skills** are developing but limited — sustaining a back-and-forth exchange is currently difficult, and she benefits from a patient interlocutor who allows processing time

3. Learning Objectives

The following three objectives reflect Déborah's validated professional goals and confirmed priorities. They are designed to be achievable within the proposed 10-hour training plan and directly applicable to her daily role at the HEC welcome desk.

Gérer un appel téléphonique professionnel en anglais avec assurance pour orienter interlocuteurs et résoudre des problèmes simples.

Rédiger des courriels professionnels clairs et structurés en anglais afin de gérer les échanges écrits de manière autonome.

Expliquer un problème simple et proposer une solution adaptée pour accompagner étudiants et visiteurs en toute autonomie.

4. Training Plan

| 4.1 Overview

Current Level	B1 (2)
Target Level	B1 (2) — consolidated and professionalised
Total Training Hours	10 hours
Recommended Format	Video call (visio)
Preferred Day	Wednesday afternoons
Also Available	Tuesday and Friday afternoons
Ideal Start Date	September 2026
Homework	Yes — confirmed willing

| 4.2 Hours Breakdown

Component	Hours
Coached sessions (visio)	8 hours
Guided self-study / homework	2 hours
Total	10 hours

Sessions are recommended at **1 hour per week**, progressing through the four priority content areas below over approximately two months from the confirmed start date.

| 4.3 Priority Content Areas

The following areas are sequenced from foundational to applied, reflecting both Déborah's learning profile (hands-on, practical, non-academic) and her stated priorities (telephone English and problem-solving first):

- **Professional telephone English** — greeting callers, asking for and confirming information, transferring calls, taking messages, closing a call politely; includes functional fixed phrases and role-play practice
- **Spoken interaction at the welcome desk** — directing visitors and students, explaining rules and procedures, managing unexpected questions; includes strategies for maintaining conversation when vocabulary is not immediately available (paraphrasing, buying time)
- **Professional email writing** — developing a set of templates for Déborah's most frequent email types (informing, redirecting, explaining a problem, following up); focus on structure, register, opening and closing conventions, and key collocations
- **Grammar in professional context** — irregular past simple forms, future and conditional structures (*would like to, will, going to, present progressive for plans*), plural morphology, and prepositions of place; all grammar presented through professional scenarios rather than abstract exercises

| 4.4 Learner Profile Notes

- Déborah **watches films and television in English** regularly — this habit should be acknowledged and leveraged; the trainer may suggest targeted listening tasks using accessible media between sessions
- She describes herself as preferring a **hands-on, practical approach** over academic study — training materials should prioritise realistic workplace scenarios, role-plays, and usable output (templates, phrase banks, scripts) over grammar explanation for its own sake
- She has expressed that **confidence** is a core need alongside accuracy — the trainer should create low-stakes, repetition-rich opportunities for spoken production, particularly in the early sessions, before introducing more complex or unpredictable interaction tasks
- She is **happy to complete homework** between sessions, which represents a valuable additional learning channel — short, focused tasks (10–15 minutes) tied directly to session content are recommended

5. Evaluator Narrative Summary

Déborah Vichith presents as a **motivated, self-aware learner** whose English profile is shaped by a clear and consistent pattern: strong receptive skills, good pronunciation, and a genuine communicative drive on one side; limited spoken fluency, restricted grammatical range, and reduced confidence in spontaneous interaction on the other.

Her written test result of **B1+ (2.5)** reflects a solid intermediate foundation — she knows more English grammar than she can currently produce under real-time pressure, which is an encouraging starting position. Her oral assessment, however, revealed that this knowledge does not yet translate into fluent or confident spoken interaction. The gap between her listening comprehension (B1) and her speaking output (A2) is the most defining feature of her current profile, and it points directly to where training effort should be concentrated: not on building new knowledge, but on **activating and automatising the language she already has** in professional, real-world contexts.

Her role at the HEC main reception demands a specific and relatively contained set of English competencies — greeting and directing visitors and students, answering questions about procedures and accommodation, managing simple problems, transferring calls, and writing clear professional emails. These are achievable targets within a 10-hour training framework, provided the content is consistently grounded in her actual daily scenarios. Generic intermediate English instruction would be a poor fit for both her profile and her timeline; **role-specific, output-focused training** is the appropriate approach.

Two habits flagged during the oral session deserve particular trainer attention. First, Déborah's use of *"that's it"* as a spoken exit strategy — a phrase she deploys to signal she has nothing more to say, often prematurely — will need to be directly addressed and replaced with productive communication strategies: paraphrasing, asking for clarification, using fillers appropriately, and attempting a response even when vocabulary is imperfect. Second, her inconsistent use of plural morphology in speech (*phone call, professor, persons*) suggests these forms have not been automatised and will benefit from targeted, high-frequency repetition in meaningful contexts.

On a positive note, Déborah's pronunciation is a genuine asset. Her self-correction behaviour during the oral session indicates active phonological monitoring that many B1 learners do not yet demonstrate. Her listening comprehension is sufficiently strong to support interactive speaking practice from the first session. And her practical orientation — illustrated by her use of television and film as autonomous learning tools — suggests she will engage readily with task-based, scenario-driven instruction.

With focused training, consistent homework engagement, and a trainer approach that prioritises confidence-building alongside accuracy, Déborah has the profile and the motivation to reach a **consolidated, professionalised B1 level** that will allow her to perform her reception role in English with autonomy and assurance.

6. Sign-Off

Evaluator

Anna MALZY

Organisation

Linguaid France

Written Test Date	18 June 2026
Oral Session Date	24 June 2026
Report Completed	June 2026

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